

ROOTS

As the lifeline of a plant, roots draw nutrients from the soil and carry them to the leaves and flowers. Thick and fibrous in texture, they contain potent organic compounds that make them an excellent ingredient for herbal tisanes.

Roots have their own microculture of organisms, insects, and nutrients, which gives them health-giving properties. If growing in temperate areas, the roots absorb nutrients from the soil and store them during winter, when the plant's metabolism slows down. They are best harvested on a dry day in spring, just as the plant comes to life. Roots can either be hung to dry, provided they are not too thick or soft, or dried slowly in a dehydrator. Predried roots are widely available to buy as well.



BURDOCK ROOT

(*Arctium*)

Part of the same plant that produces burrs—the prickly seed pods that stick to clothing when brushed against—the taproot of the burdock plant can grow up to 24in (60cm) in length. It contains inulin, a compound that supports probiotic health in the colon. Burdock root has been used to treat acne and joint pain, and is a good diuretic and blood-purifying agent. It is often used in detox tisanes as it helps cleanse the liver.

**ROASTED DRIED
ROOTS CAN BE USED
AS CAFFEINE-FREE
TEA SUBSTITUTES**

LICORICE

(*Glycyrrhiza glabra*)

This fibrous root imparts sweetness to a tisane. It can improve respiratory health by soothing inflamed mucous membranes of the throat and lungs, providing relief from colds; it similarly helps with ailments of the stomach and intestine. Licorice is also used as a detoxifier and mood-enhancing tonic.

